Mithril Atomics

BRAND GUIDELINES

"Precision that doesn't need to shout."

Version 2.0 — August 2026

Quantum sensing systems

Brand philosophy

Mithril Atomics builds instruments that measure the physical world at its smallest, most exacting scale. The name pairs two ideas: mithril, a material prized for being flawless under pressure, and atomics, precision at the scale of the atom. Together they describe a company whose confidence comes from rigor, not spectacle.

Positioning statement

"Precision that doesn't need to shout."

The brand should read the way a well-made scientific instrument looks: exact, restrained, and built to be trusted rather than admired for its decoration.

Brand attributes

- **Precise**

  Every visual and verbal choice is deliberate — nothing decorative for its own sake.

- **Restrained**

  Confidence is shown through clarity and negative space, not ornamentation or bold claims.

- **Rigorous**

  The brand should feel evidence-based and technically credible in every context.

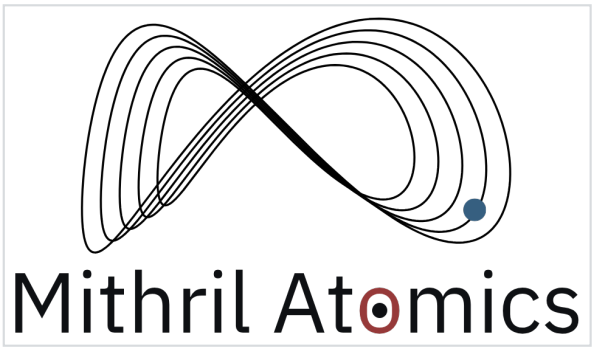
- **Quietly futuristic**

  Forward-looking without relying on clichés like neon gradients or glow effects.

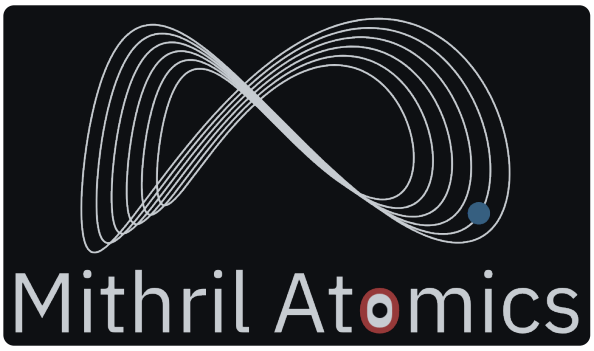
Logo

The mark pairs an icon and a wordmark, always used together. The icon traces a real Lorenz attractor — a chaotic system that looks unpredictable but is governed by an exact, repeatable law, echoing what the company actually does: finding precise, repeatable measurement inside systems that look uncertain from the outside. The two loops also read as a soft, unforced M.

For light backgrounds



For dark backgrounds



The wordmark

- Set in IBM Plex Sans, Medium weight, sentence case.
- The "O" in "Atomics" is capitalized and rendered as a small ring with a dark center dot — a deliberate nod to an atomic nucleus. This is a wordmark-only exception; "Atomics" is written normally (lowercase o) everywhere else, in running text.

Two fixed ink variants

- Graphite ink (icon + wordmark) for light or white backgrounds.
- Platinum ink (icon + wordmark) for dark backgrounds.
- The red ring, its center dot, and the steel-blue accent dot on the icon stay the same color in both variants — only the primary ink swaps.

Color palette

A tight, low-saturation palette keeps the brand feeling like an instrument, not an app. Two accent colors are used, each reserved for a single, specific role — never as a field, never interchangeably.

Graphite #0E1013	Primary ink for light backgrounds. Icon + wordmark.
Platinum #C7CCD1	Primary ink for dark backgrounds. Icon + wordmark.
Steel blue #365F80	Accent. Used only for the single dot on the icon curve.
Signal red #963939	Accent. Used only for the ring of the O in "Atomics" — nowhere else.
Off-white #F5F6F7	Background for print and light-mode surfaces.
Muted grey #5B6570	Secondary and supporting text, captions.

Rule

Signal red never appears anywhere except inside the wordmark's O. It is not a general brand accent — introducing it elsewhere would dilute the one deliberate use it has.

Avoid

Any other saturated colors, bright gradients, drop shadows, or glow effects — these undercut the precision-over-spectacle positioning.

Typography

The brand typeface is IBM Plex Sans — a geometric grotesk with a measured, technical character, used consistently across the wordmark and all brand materials. Headlines are set in Medium or Bold weight with generous letter-spacing. Body copy stays Regular weight, tightly kerned, and highly legible at small sizes.

Heading one

Heading two

Body text. Mithril Atomics builds instruments for quantum-scale measurement. Copy stays factual and unadorned, set at a size and line length built for reading, not for effect.

Caption / supporting label

Rules

- Two weights only — Regular for body, Medium or Bold for headlines and the wordmark. Avoid Light or Thin weights; they undercut the engineered feel at small sizes.
- Sentence case for all running copy. Full caps are reserved for short labels only, always with added letter-spacing.
- The capitalized, styled "O" in the wordmark is a one-time exception specific to the logo — do not capitalize or stylize other letters elsewhere.
- Keep paragraphs to roughly 60-75 characters per line for readability.

Voice, imagery & logo usage

Voice & tone

- Say less, precisely — lead with what was measured, not with adjectives.
- Avoid hype language such as "revolutionary" or "game-changing"; let the specification speak for itself.
- Prefer active, technical language over marketing language.

Imagery style

- Favor macro photography of metal, lab equipment, and instrumentation over generic stock "tech" imagery.
- Lighting should be controlled and directional, not bright and even.
- Avoid clichéd sci-fi visuals: neon circuit patterns, glowing holograms, generic outer-space backdrops.

Logo usage principles

- Maintain clear space around the mark equal to the height of the wordmark.
- Never recolor, distort, rotate, or add effects such as shadows, glows, or gradients to the mark.
- Always match the ink variant to the background: graphite version on light surfaces, platinum version on dark surfaces — never mix the two.
- The signal-red ring and its center dot, and the steel-blue dot on the icon, stay fixed in both ink variants — never recolored to match the swap.
- Maintain a defined minimum size so the mark stays legible at small scale, such as a favicon or app icon.